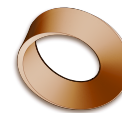


Name: _____

Date: _____

Mr. Rawson • Y8 MYP Design



Criterion A — Inquiring and analysing

What you are marked on — and what it is not

1 • MakeCode — learn to code

Most of your lessons are in **MakeCode**, dragging blocks together to make the micro:bit do things — variables, decisions, loops. This is how you will *build* your game, later in the unit.

2 • Design a game

You get to choose your own game and design it, for one real person or group. Your **A and B summative** marks the design work *only* — your research and your planning. The game itself is not marked this time.

Criterion A is marked **out of 8**, in **four strands**, and your summative asks you to do all four. **Keep this sheet.** Read *down* a column to see how one strand gets better, and *across* a row to see what a whole level looks like. The green row at the bottom says what each strand means **on this project**.

Level	i • the need <i>...for a game, not a problem</i>	ii • the research plan <i>...before you design anything</i>	iii • analysing <i>...games that inspire yours</i>	iv • the design brief <i>...built from your research</i>
0	The student does not reach a standard described by any of the descriptors below.			
1–2	states the need	states some of the main findings of your research	—	—
3–4	outlines the need	states the research needed — with some guidance	outlines one existing game	develops a basic brief, outlining some of the research
5–6	explains the need	constructs a plan that states and prioritises primary and secondary research — with some guidance	describes a group of similar games	develops a brief that outlines the findings of the research
7–8	explains and justifies the need	the same plan, done independently	analyses a group of similar games	develops a brief that presents the analysis of the research
On our project	Who is your game for, and why would they want to play it?	Play some real games. Ask the person it is for what they like. Then say what matters most.	Name two games you considered, and say why you chose your own instead.	Who it is for, what kind of game, and what yours is — grown out of your research.

The words that move you up — the strand barely changes between levels, the *verb* does:

states you wrote it down
outlines you gave the short version
describes you said what it is really like
explains you said *why*
analyses you broke it apart
justifies you argued for it

Where the marks actually go. Criterion A is marked entirely on **the thinking you write down before you build anything** — who it is for, what you found out, and what that means for your design.

Nobody moves up a band by picking a harder game. They move up by **writing more carefully about the games they looked at.**

Criterion B — Developing ideas

Turning what you found out into a plan somebody could build

Criterion B is also marked **out of 8**, in **four strands**. Criterion A was about what you *found out*. Criterion B is about what you *decided* — and whether somebody else could pick up your plan and build your game from it.

Level	i · the specification <i>...what "finished" means</i>	ii · your design ideas <i>...more than one, so there is a choice</i>	iii · the chosen design <i>...and why that one</i>	iv · planning drawings <i>...so somebody else could build it</i>
0	The student does not reach a standard described by any of the descriptors below.			
1–2	lists a few basic success criteria	presents one design idea, which others can interpret	—	creates incomplete planning drawings/diagrams [†]
3–4	constructs a list of the success criteria	presents a few feasible ideas, <i>or</i> explains their key features	outlines the main reasons for your choice, against your spec	creates planning drawings/diagrams <i>or</i> lists requirements
5–6	develops a specification identifying the success criteria	presents a range of feasible ideas and explains their key features	presents the chosen design and outlines the main reasons, against your spec	develops accurate drawings/diagrams and lists requirements
7–8	a specification whose criteria come from the data you collected	a range of ideas, using annotation, which others can correctly interpret	presents the chosen design and outlines the reasons, against your spec	accurate drawings/diagrams and outlines the requirements
On our project	What must your game do to count as finished? Write it so somebody could tick each one off.	Three different versions of your game, sketched. Not three games — three takes on yours.	Say which one you are building, and point at your own spec to explain why.	A drawing of what is on the screen, and a list of the blocks you will need.

[†] In the official grid this bottom-band descriptor is numbered *iii*, not *iv*. It is printed here under *iv* so that each column stays about one thing all the way down. Same descriptor, same mark.

One idea caps you at 2.

Look at strand **ii** at level 1–2: *presents one design idea*. That is the whole descriptor.

So if you have one idea, however good it is, that strand cannot go above **2**. Three rough sketches beat one neat one, every single time.

A specification is not a wish.

Wish *It should be fun.*

Spec *Two people can play it at once, and a round lasts under 30 seconds.*

The test: **could somebody else hold your game and tick it off?** If not, it is a wish.

What You Actually Hand In

Eight pieces — one for each strand of A and B

Every piece below feeds exactly one strand. Nothing here is padding, and nothing is optional — **a missing piece is a strand scored zero.**

✓	What you hand in	Strand	How long	What takes it from 5–6 to 7–8
☐	1 Two games you considered — named, plus why you chose your own over them	A iii	30–60 words <i>per game</i>	Strengths and weaknesses. An analysis that only praises is not an analysis.
☐	2 Who each of those games was made for, and how you can tell	A iii	1–2 sentences <i>each</i>	Point at the <i>evidence in the game</i> . Not “it’s for little kids” — “it’s for little kids, because a round lasts ten seconds and you cannot lose.”
☐	3 Your research plan — what you still need to find out, in order	A ii	—	Put it in priority order , and say why the top one is top. Include asking a real person, not only looking things up.
☐	4 Why does your game need to exist? Who is it for?	A i	—	Justify it, don’t just explain it. Say what this person gets out of your game that they would not get from any other one.
☐	5 Your design brief — who it is for, what kind of game, and your game in one sentence	A iv	—	Present the analysis , not just the findings. Your brief should clearly have grown out of piece 1.
☐	6 Your success criteria — what your game must do to count as finished	B i	5–8 lines	Each one must be tickable by somebody else . Build them out of what you found in your research, not out of thin air.
☐	7 Three sketches — three different versions of <i>your</i> game	B ii	3 sketches	Annotate them. Labels and arrows saying what each part does. An unlabelled sketch cannot be “correctly interpreted”.
☐	8 Which one you are building, and why — plus a screen plan and your list of blocks	B iii B iv	—	Point at your own spec when you justify the choice. Then draw what is on the 5×5 screen, and list the blocks you will need to make it happen.

The Two Things That Decide Your Grade

1. Describing is not analysing.

Piece 1 is your biggest block of writing, and all of Criterion A strand iii turns on this.

Saying “*it’s a fun game*” tells a reader almost nothing. Saying **why** it works, and **what effect** it has on the person playing, is what turns a description into an analysis.

Weak *Hot Potato is a fun game where you pass the micro:bit around.*

Strong *In Hot Potato the timer is a random length, so nobody can count down in their head and dump it on the last second. That is what makes people panic and throw it, which is where the laughing comes from. It only works with a group standing in a circle — two people sitting at a desk would find it boring in a minute.*

The strong one does three things, **in this order**:

what is actually there → **the effect it has** → **who it is for**.

Do those three every time, and strand iii looks after itself.

2. Your spec is the spine of everything after it.

Once you have written your success criteria, **every later piece points back at them**. You choose your design *because* it meets them. You draw your screen *because* it delivers them. Later in the unit you will test your finished game *against* them.

A vague spec makes every one of those impossible. Write it carefully once, and the rest of the project has something to stand on.

Before you hand it in

- ☐ All **eight** pieces are there. A missing piece is a strand scored zero.
- ☐ I compared my game with **two** others I considered.
- ☐ Every game I analysed has a **weakness**, not only praise.
- ☐ My research plan is **in priority order**, and says why.
- ☐ I asked **a real person** something, not only looked things up.
- ☐ I said what my game gives **this person** that another game would not.
- ☐ I have **three** sketches, not one — and they are **labelled**.
- ☐ Every success criterion could be **ticked off by somebody else**.
- ☐ When I explain my choice, I **point at my own spec**.
- ☐ My design brief says “**so**” at least once — “*they get bored quickly, so a round in my game lasts under a minute.*”